Oil leaking through Hormuz to keep prices lower

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【要点】

・ホルムズ海峡を通じて1日約500万バレルの石油が流通しており、イラン制限下でもブレント油価を75～95ドル範囲に抑えて米国のエスカレーション圧力を緩和している。

・米国とカナダは8月19日のセクション338関税期限前に限定的な貿易協定を締結する見通しで（確率70%）、これによりUSMCAと防衛協議の本格化が期待される。

・トランプ政権は中国のバイオテクノロジー部門へのアクセス制限に対し、業界全体規制ではなく標的化した企業レベルのツールを活用する方針で、9月の米中サミットが注視点である。

・ブラジルの大統領選挙はルーラ現大統領とボルソナーロ上院議員で激戦状況にあり、ボルソナーロ候補の支持率低下が第三の選択肢の道を広げる可能性がある。

・イランとの紛争激化は低下しており、米国とイランは徐々に緊張緩和に向かい、今後数週間以内に海峡再開の合意に至る見込みである。

【メール原文】

About 5 million barrels per day is transiting the Strait of Hormuz despite Iranian restrictions, which is keeping Brent in a $75–$95 range and easing ||||||||||||||||

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summary

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About 5 million barrels per day is transiting the Strait of Hormuz despite Iranian restrictions, which is keeping Brent in a $75–$95 range and easing US pressure to escalate.
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A limited US-Canada trade deal is in view before the 19 August Section 338 tariff deadline, which would unlock broader United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) and defense talks.
*
US President Donald Trump's team will use targeted firm-level tools to curb China's access to the US biotech sector, and the September US-China summit is the key watchpoint.
*
Brazil's election between President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva and Senator Flavio Bolsonaro is highly competitive—and Bolsonaro's weakening standing could widen the path for a third option.
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Regions, countries, and sectors covered in this edition include the US, Brazil, Canada, China, the Middle East and North Africa, Oman, oil, geo-technology, sustainability, and trade.

the top line

Oil, Iran—Oil leaking through the Gulf will help keep prices lower

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Escalation in the US-Iran conflict appears less likely, with the US and Iran now slowly moving toward de-escalation and a deal to reopen the strait in the coming weeks.

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About 5 million barrels per day (bpd) are moving through the Strait of Hormuz despite Iranian restrictions, helping to keep prices low and easing the pressure on the US to escalate.

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The impact of these flows is partially offset by the disruption to Saudi oil loadings in the Red Sea, where Houthi attacks have affected loadings from the port of Yanbu.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: ecr@eurasiagroup.net .

US, Canada—Limited trade deal would unlock USMCA talks

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Trump's Section 338 tariff threat has unlocked US-Canada negotiations, with a limited trade deal now in view that would prevent their imposition before the 19 August deadline (70% probability).

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Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney is now likely prepared to accept a limited deal—linking the rollback of Ottawa's retaliatory measures as well as marginal dairy concessions to reductions in US Section 232 tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminum—as a stepping stone to more comprehensive USMCA and defense negotiations.

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Failure to make sufficient progress in ongoing talks would result in Section 338 tariffs being imposed on schedule, which would lead both sides to pull back and push any potential trade deal further into the future.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: canada@eurasiagroup.net .

China, US—US will deploy targeted measures on China biotech over sector-wide restrictions

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Congressional efforts to restrict Chinese access to the US biotech sector will intensify in 2026, as lawmakers advance legislation framing China's biotech gains as a national security and competitiveness risk.

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The Trump administration will channel its response through Treasury rulemaking and BIOSECURE designations rather than sector-wide outbound investment restrictions under the Comprehensive Outbound Investment National Security Act (COINS Act).

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The September summit between Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping is the key watchpoint for whether the detente that underpins Eurasia Group's basecase for the bilateral relationship holds.
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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: healthcare@eurasiagroup.net .

Brazil—Bolsonaro weakening could widen path for a third option

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Surveys are split on whether Lula's lead over Bolsonaro is narrowing or stable, pointing to a highly competitive race. Barred from publicity since July, Lula has been slightly on the defensive. The campaign's start next week should restore his agenda-setting ability, though corruption scandals remain.
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For alternative conservatives, reaching the runoff hinges on eroding Bolsonaro's standing. Former Goias Governor Ronaldo Caiado (Social Democratic Party) is attacking Bolsonaro on corruption while courting his base with a security-first platform. Among the 22% preferring neither frontrunner, 55% are uncommitted; Our odds of a non-Bolsonaro runoff are 30%.
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Congress began pre-election sessions on 10 August. Most legislators are home campaigning, keeping quorum scarce—unlikely to advance the administration's priorities. A critical minerals framework, AI regulation, and a reduced workweek bill will likely slip past October's elections.
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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

MENA, Trade—Hormuz disruption positions Duqm to attract rerouted supply chain investment

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Duqm is best placed to attract supply chain redundancy investment driven by Hormuz disruption risk, as the Omani port city combines direct Arabian Sea access with an integrated industrial platform, significant expansion capacity, and logistics infrastructure.
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Yanbu, on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast, offers proven energy export potential but faces physical capacity constraints that limit its role as a diversified logistics and manufacturing platform.
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Bypass corridors through Iraq and Syria face high execution risk and weak commercial fundamentals relative to established port infrastructure on the Arabian Peninsula.
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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net.

China—Chart of the day: Chinese capital markets are taking a greater role funding private firms

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The last week has seen a surge in shares sales in China, led by tech firms that increasingly need access to capital for China's AI buildout. The Shanghai free trade zone bond market also saw the first non-financial firm issue debt since 2023.
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Over the last year, increased global competition for capital due to AI investment, defence spending and aging demographics have reinforced the US advantage from its large, well developed capital markets.
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There are early signs political support for financial market development may be shifting within China, potentially complementing efforts to internationalize the yuan though trade settlement and commodity trading.
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Read more here . Reach out to discuss geoeconomics@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

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13 August 10:00 AM ET—Analysing global oil & gas markets. Register here .
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17 August 12:30 AM ET—India update. Register here .

eg in depth

US, Geo-technology—Polysilicon 232 tariffs trade higher solar costs for US reshoring

The US will impose minimum import prices on polysilicon and solar products, plus a 15% tariff on select downstream goods effective 4 December. With Chinese overcapacity pushing polysilicon prices well below Western production costs, the combination of price floor and tariffs is designed to reset US pricing. Investment-linked waivers incentivize domestic capacity. The biggest pressure point is the mid-supply chain: the US has 70 GW of module assembly but only 3–3.2 GW of cell capacity, leaving manufacturers reliant on imported wafers and cells. Tariffing these inputs raises near-term costs for firms still using the 45X manufacturing credit but should accelerate upstream integration. Southeast Asian and Indian exporters face the greatest exposure. South Korea could be advantaged as its tariff ceiling and price floor narrow the price gap with lower-cost Asian competitors. Spillover to semiconductors is likely to be more limited. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net .

Sustainability—Wildfires will expose limits of environmental governance and market frameworks

Wildfires are on track to rival agriculture as the leading driver of global forest destruction—an unprecedented shift that is unlikely to reverse. Wildfire-driven diplomatic disputes will likely fade with the fire season, leaving no durable cross-border agreements and deepening G-Zero fragmentation. Forest loss will erode the forest carbon storage capacity that corporate sustainability strategies depend on, but open new demand for data-driven insurance products. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: sustainability@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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12 August: Data: US and Russia CPI.
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13 August: Events: Zambia holds presidential and parliamentary elections; UK Clacton parliamentary by-election is held following Reform Leader Nigel Farage’s decision to quit as an MP and recontest the seat; Data: Argentina CPI, US and Japan PPI, UK GDP, Eurozone industrial production; Central bank decision: Peru and Norway.

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14 August: Data: Eurozone GDP and unemployment; US retail sales, business inventories, University of Michigan consumer sentiment, France, Poland, and Israel CPI.

closing quip

US forces operating in the Middle East are highly vigilant, lethal, and ready”—US Central Command said in a statement on 11 August. The US military targeted a Panama-flagged container ship that defied a US naval blockade on Iran while attempting to reach an Iranian port via the Gulf of Oman.

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